

Unit 1 of "Communicative English":

Fundamentals of Communication Skills

1. Scope and Significance of Communication Skills

Scope of Communication Skills:

Communication skills encompass a broad spectrum of activities related to the exchange of information. These skills are fundamental in every context, whether it's an academic environment, professional setting, or everyday social interactions. Here's a breakdown of the scope:

1. **In Academics:** Communication allows students to effectively express their ideas and engage with complex concepts. Through communication, students can collaborate on projects, participate in discussions, and gain feedback. Teachers use communication to deliver lessons and encourage participation.
2. **In the Workplace:** Professional settings rely heavily on clear and efficient communication. This includes everything from daily conversations with colleagues to formal presentations and reports. Effective communication in the workplace leads to better teamwork, productivity, and decision-making.
3. **In Personal Life:** Good communication skills help in resolving conflicts, building relationships, and understanding others better. Whether it's verbal, non-verbal, or written, communication influences how people connect with one another.

Significance of Communication Skills:

The significance of communication skills is profound as they impact various aspects of life:

1. **Clarity in Thought and Action:** Good communication skills ensure that messages are conveyed clearly and concisely, avoiding misunderstandings. Whether giving instructions or making a request, the ability to express oneself effectively ensures that the desired outcome is achieved.

2. **Improved Interpersonal Relationships:** Effective communication helps build trust and understanding between individuals, fostering better relationships. This applies to both personal and professional connections.
3. **Career Advancement:** In professional settings, employees with excellent communication skills are often viewed as leaders and may progress faster in their careers. Being able to articulate thoughts, share ideas, and present information clearly makes a significant difference.
4. **Conflict Resolution:** Proper communication can help in resolving conflicts by ensuring all parties understand each other's viewpoints and concerns.

2. Listening

Definition :

Listening is an active process of receiving, constructing meaning from, and responding to spoken or written messages. Listening is not just hearing; it involves understanding, interpreting, and giving feedback.

Types of Listening :

1. **Active Listening :** This involves fully concentrating on what the speaker is saying, understanding the message, and responding thoughtfully. Active listening demonstrates empathy, understanding, and attentiveness. Techniques include nodding, asking questions, and giving verbal feedback like "I understand" or "Could you explain further?"
2. **Passive Listening :** In passive listening, one hears the message but doesn't actively engage or respond. This can lead to misunderstandings or missed information since there is no feedback mechanism. For example, when listening to background noise while focusing on another task.

3. **Reflective Listening** : This involves paraphrasing or reflecting back what the speaker has said, demonstrating that you've understood the message. It helps to clarify the content and provides reassurance to the speaker that they are being heard.

Importance of Listening :

- **Enhances Understanding** : Active listening allows the listener to fully comprehend the speaker's message. Misunderstandings are reduced, leading to more effective communication.
- **Builds Relationships** : By showing genuine interest in what someone is saying, active listeners build rapport and trust with the speaker.
- **Improves Problem-Solving** : Listening attentively helps in gathering all the information needed to make informed decisions, especially in collaborative settings.

Techniques to Improve Listening :

- **Maintain Eye Contact** : Eye contact signals attentiveness and shows the speaker that you're engaged.
- **Minimize Distractions** : Eliminating external distractions allows for focused listening, which improves comprehension.
- **Ask Questions** : Clarifying any ambiguous points ensures that the message is understood correctly.
- **Summarize** : After listening, briefly summarizing the key points helps to reinforce understanding.

3. Speaking

Definition :

Speaking is the verbal expression of thoughts, ideas, emotions, or information. It involves conveying messages clearly and effectively to an audience, which can be one person or a group.

Aspects of Speaking :

1. Pronunciation : Correct pronunciation is essential for clear communication. Mispronouncing words can lead to misunderstandings.
2. **Tone** : The tone of your voice conveys emotions and can affect how your message is received. A warm and friendly tone can make your message more welcoming, while a harsh tone might create distance.
3. **Clarity** : It's crucial to speak clearly and at a moderate pace to ensure your message is understood. Avoid mumbling or speaking too fast.
4. Structuring Speech : Effective speaking often follows a clear structure. Begin with an introduction, follow up with key points (body), and conclude by summarizing your message.

Importance of Speaking :

- Confidence and Persuasion : Effective speaking helps in persuading others, building confidence, and establishing credibility. In professional settings, public speaking is a key skill for leaders.
- Conveying Information : Speaking is the primary means of sharing information, instructions, and ideas, whether in a classroom, workplace, or social context.
- Fostering Collaboration : In group settings, speaking allows individuals to share their viewpoints, thus fostering collaboration and decision-making.

Techniques for Effective Speaking :

- Practice : Regular practice improves fluency and confidence.
- Focus on Body Language : Non-verbal cues such as gestures, eye contact, and posture complement verbal communication and enhance message delivery.
- Use Simple Language : Avoid jargon or complex words unless necessary. The goal is for your audience to understand the message.

4. Reading

Definition :

Reading is the process of interpreting written symbols (letters, words, sentences) to derive meaning. It is a fundamental skill that underpins all areas of learning.

Types of Reading :

1. Skimming : This involves quickly going through the text to get a general idea or overview. Skimming is useful for previewing or reviewing materials.
2. Scanning : This technique is used when looking for specific information, like searching for a particular date or statistic in a document.
3. Intensive Reading : This is detailed reading for full understanding of a text, often used in studying complex materials.
4. Extensive Reading : Involves reading longer texts for enjoyment or overall comprehension, like reading a novel or magazine.

Importance of Reading :

- Knowledge Acquisition : Reading allows individuals to access a wide range of information and perspectives. It is essential for learning and staying informed.
- Improves Vocabulary and Grammar : Through reading, people encounter new words and sentence structures, which improves their language skills.
- Critical Thinking : Analyzing and interpreting texts fosters critical thinking skills. Readers learn to evaluate the information, discern biases, and form their own opinions.

Techniques for Effective Reading :

- Preview the Material : Skim the headings, subheadings, and summaries before starting to read to get an idea of the content.

- Annotate the Text : Highlighting or underlining key points and making notes in the margins can help retain important information.
- Summarize : After reading a section, briefly summarize the key points to reinforce comprehension.

5. Writing

Definition :

Writing is the process of creating text to communicate ideas, thoughts, and information. It involves structuring sentences and paragraphs in a coherent and organized manner.

Types of Writing :

- Descriptive : Writing that creates vivid images in the reader's mind, often used in stories and essays.
- Narrative : Storytelling that includes a beginning, middle, and end.
- Persuasive : Writing aimed at convincing the reader of a particular viewpoint, often used in advertisements, essays, or speeches.
- Expository : Writing that explains or informs, commonly seen in textbooks, manuals, and reports.

Importance of Writing :

- Expression of Ideas : Writing allows individuals to organize their thoughts and communicate complex ideas effectively.
- Professional Relevance : In most professions, written communication is essential, whether it's crafting emails, reports, or presentations.
- Develops Analytical Skills : Writing often requires analysis and synthesis of information, helping individuals develop deeper thinking skills.

Techniques for Effective Writing :

- Plan and Organize : Start by outlining your main points before writing to ensure clarity and structure.
- Be Concise : Avoid unnecessary words or overly complex sentences.
- Proofread : Always check for grammar, punctuation, and spelling errors before finalizing a piece of writing.

Technical Communication

Definition :

Technical communication is a specialized form of communication used to convey information in fields such as engineering, science, and information technology.

Forms of Technical Communication :

- Reports : Detailed documents presenting findings, analyses, or recommendations.
- Memos : Brief messages used for internal communication within organizations.
- Emails : Commonly used for both formal and informal exchanges of information.
- Presentations : Visual and oral methods used to share technical information.

Importance of Technical Communication :

- Precision and Clarity : Technical communication ensures that complex information is conveyed accurately, which is critical in fields like engineering or software development.
- Objective Information : Focuses on facts rather than opinions, ensuring that the information is reliable and usable.
- Jargon and Terminology : Technical communication often involves industry-specific terminology, which must be understood by the intended audience.

. Tools of Effective Communication

1. Verbal Tools :

- Language : Use simple, clear words suited to the audience.
- Tone : A respectful and positive tone makes communication more effective.
- Pacing & Volume : Speak at a moderate pace with proper volume to ensure clarity.

2. Non-Verbal Tools :

- Body Language : Open posture and appropriate gestures enhance the message.
- Eye Contact : Shows attentiveness and builds rapport.
- Facial Expressions : Use expressions to match the emotion behind your words.

3. Listening Tools :

- Active Listening : Focus on the speaker and give verbal or non-verbal feedback.
- Clarification : Ask questions to ensure understanding.

4. Written Tools :

- Clarity & Precision : Write clearly and concisely, with correct grammar.
- Formatting : Organize text with headings and bullet points for better readability.

5. Visual Tools :

- Charts & Diagrams : Simplify complex information.
- Images : Support text with relevant visuals to aid understanding.

6. Paralinguistic Tools :

- Pitch & Intonation : Vary tone to emphasize key points.
- Pauses : Use pauses for emphasis and to let the audience process information.

Communication Skills

Unit – 2 notes

⇒ **Parts of Speech**

- *Parts of speech can be defined as words that perform different roles in a sentence. The Oxford Learner's Dictionary defines parts of speech as "one of the classes into which words are divided according to their grammar, such as noun, verb, adjective, etc."*

Parts of speech include nouns, pronouns, verbs, adverbs, adjectives, prepositions, conjunctions and interjections.

Noun

The noun is the name of any person, place, or thing. The noun "thing" includes all the things which have a name and can be seen, tasted, heard, touched, or smelled by you. It also includes anything that we could think of, but our feelings cannot comprehend.

For Example:

- Rey is a good girl. Here Rey is the name of a person; hence, it is a noun.
- Switzerland is breathtaking. Here Switzerland is the name of a place. Hence it is a noun.

Proper Noun - It is the name of a particular person or place. For example, Rey is a good girl. Here Rey is a proper noun.

Common Noun - The name of any generalised group or community, class or kind. The name shared by a common type of person or person is a common noun. For example, Rey is a good girl. Here the girl is a common noun. My dog's name is Dobby. Here the dog is a common noun and Dobby proper noun.

Collective Noun - It describes a collection of people or things. For example, The crowds in the market suffocate me. The crowd is a collective noun.

Abstract Noun - It is the name of quality, action, or state. E.g., honesty is important. Here honesty is an abstract noun.

Countable and Uncountable Noun - It describes if the name of objects or people is countable or not. For example, doctors are countable, but sugar and milk are uncountable entities.

Pronoun

The Pronoun is the word which we use instead of a noun. For say, if we keep using a person's name in writing or speech, it would be an inappropriate sentence and will take away the essence of the sentence. Hence instead of using the name, we use a pronoun to denote that person or thing. The pronoun's words include I, me, she, he, you, us, their, ours, etc. Following are the examples:

Roger is in my class. He is intelligent.

In the above sentence, we have to use He to denote Roger.

I love novels, and this is my book.

In the above sentence, I use I, myself, to denote ourselves instead of using our name.

Adjective

It is the word that describes or stresses the quality of the noun or person, place, or thing. The following example will help you understand better.

Ben is a clever boy.

Here, the adjective Clever describes Ben.

I do not like that book.

In the above sentence, if you say which book? "That" points out the book. Hence, that is an adjective here.

Verb

A verb is a word that describes the state of a person or thing. A verb tells us what a person or thing does, or what has been done to a person or thing. They are the action words that describe the action done by a person or thing. For example,

- Sia is singing. (So singing is an activity performed by Sia. Hence, it is a verb)
- The dog died. (The word died describes the state of the dog)
- A verb is mainly of two types: transitive and intransitive.
- He kicked the man. (Transitive verb)
- He never kicks. (Intransitive verb)

TRANSITIVE VERBS



Transitive verbs are verbs that take an object.

Example:
She heard a noise.

subject – she
verb – heard
object – a noise

INTRANSITIVE VERBS



Intransitive verbs do not take an object after them.

Example:
The baby smiled.

Here, the verb **smiled is intransitive because it has no object.**

Adverb

It is a word that adds meaning or adjective to the verb. The word which describes the quality of the verb is an adverb. The following are examples to make you understand better, and darkened words are adverbs.

- He quickly ran to buy medicines.
- She sang beautifully.
- They loved each other immensely.

Preposition

It is a word that is used with a noun or pronoun to establish a relation between a noun or pronoun concerning something else. Following are the examples:

- The monkeys sat under the tree.
- She lives in a big city.
- They were looking out the window.

Conjunction

A conjunction is a word that is used to join sentences or phrases. Read the below examples for a better understanding. Here, bold words are conjunctions.

- Cat **and** dog are enemies.
- Her courage **and** determination won.
- It was sunny **but** cold.
- She ran fast **but** missed the bus.

Interjection:

It is the word that expresses an exclamation that is a sudden reaction, feeling, or emotion of happiness, despair anger, etc. Follow the examples below:

- Hurray! I won.
- Alas! He is no more.
- You are a courageous person. Bravo!

Part of Speech	Description	Examples
Noun	Names a person, place, thing, or idea.	Dog, City, Happiness
Pronoun	Replaces a noun to avoid repetition.	He, She, It, They
Verb	Expresses action, occurrence, or state of being.	Run, Is, Seem, Write
Adjective	Describes or modifies a noun, giving more detail.	Happy, Blue, Large, Old
Adverb	Modifies a verb, adjective, or other adverb, describing how, when, where, or to what extent.	Quickly, Very, Soon, Outside
Preposition	Shows relationships between nouns (or pronouns) and other words in a sentence.	In, On, Under, Between
Conjunction	Connects words, phrases, or clauses within a sentence.	And, But, Or, Because
Interjection	Expresses strong emotions or reactions, often standing alone.	Wow!, Ouch!, Hey!, Oops!

Tense

A tense is a form of the verb and with the help of Tense in English language, we can tell the time of occurrence of any action whether it is happening in the past, present or future. Understanding tenses and using them correctly is important for effective communication. Tenses can be divided into three parts:

- **Present Tense**
- **Past Tense**
- **Future Tense**

Past Tense	Present Tense	Future Tense
Simple Past Tense	Simple Present Tense	Simple Future Tense
Past Continuous Tense	Present Continuous Tense	Future Continuous Tense
Past Perfect Tense	Present Perfect Tense	Future Perfect Tense
Past Perfect Continuous Tense	Present Perfect Continuous Tense	Future Perfect Continuous Tense

Present Tense Rules and Examples

The present tense rule is used to describe the current or present being, situation, or event. It is a form of the verb that defines the events that are currently happening. Examples

- I am going to the office
- She has been part of this group for 4 years now.
- The concert is going amazing.

Simple Present Tense Rules

The present indefinite tense rule or present simple tense rules represent the habitual action or a general truth of anything i.e., the Sun rises in the East. Now you can create some sentences by using the simple present tense rules which are given below:

Subject + V1 + s/es + Object (Singular)
Subject + V1 + Object (Plural)

Examples of Simple Present Tense Rules:

1. The Sun rises in the East.
2. Rita goes to school.

Present Continuous Tense Rules

Present continuous tense shows the action which is happening in the present and will continue for some finite time i.e. the team is playing very well. Now you can make some sentences using the present continuous tense rule that is given below:

Subject + is/am/are + V1 + ing + Object

Examples of Present Continuous Tense Rules:

1. I am eating pudding.
2. Sia is writing a letter to the editor.

Present Perfect Tense Rules

The present perfect tense rule shows the action that happened in the past and continues into the present i.e. I have completed the assignment. Now you can make some sentences using the present perfect tense rules that is given below:

Subject + has + V3 + Object (Singular)
Subject + have + V3 + Object (Plural)

Examples of Present Perfect Tense Rules:

1. He has just eaten food.
2. I have just read the book.

Present Perfect Continuous Tense Rules

Present perfect continuous tense shows the action that started in the past and has continued until the current instant i.e., To improve his English language, he has been doing his homework daily. Now you can make some sentences using the present perfect continuous tense rule that is given below:

Subject + has been + V1 + ing + Object (Singular)
Subject + have been + V1 + ing + Object (Plural)

Examples of Present Perfect Continuous Tense Rules:

1. I have been cleaning regularly since Monday.
2. She has been using the night cream for several months.

Past Tense Rules and Examples

Past tense is used to describe a past activity or action. It is a form of the verb that defines the events that have already occurred. Examples

- Reema attended the wedding functions.
- He left before I reached.
- Priya wrote a letter to her friends from camp.

Simple Past Tense Rules

The simple past tense represents the actions that occurred and were completed in the past i.e., I was on leave yesterday. Now you can create some sentences by using the simple past tense rules which are given below:

Subject + V2 + Object

Examples of Simple Past Tense Rules:

1. Rita went to school.
2. Minty ate food.

Past Continuous Tense Rules

The past continuous tense represents the action or actions that were occurring in the past i.e., He was dancing when I was there. Now you can create some sentences by using the past continuous tense rules which are given below:

Subject + was + V1 + ing + Object (Singular) Subject + were + V1 + ing + Object (Plural)

Examples of Past Continuous Tense Rules:

1. I was eating pudding.
2. Sia was writing a letter to the editor.

Past Perfect Tense Rules

The past perfect tense represents the action that occurred before another past action or event i.e., He had completed the assignment before the deadline. Now you can create some sentences by using the past perfect tense rules which are given below:

Subject + had + V3 + Object

Examples of Past Perfect Tense Rules:

1. He had taken the token when she called.
2. I had brushed my teeth by 8 am.

Past Perfect Continuous Tense Rules

Past Perfect Continuous Tense represents an action that started, continued and ended after some time in the past. i.e., I had been cooking my favourite dish when my sister walked into the kitchen. Now you can create some sentences by using the past perfect continuous tense rules which are given below:

Subject + had been + V1 + ing + Object

Examples of Past Perfect Continuous Tense Rules:

1. He had been standing in the rain the whole night.
2. I had been eating diet food for the whole summer.

Future Tense Rules and Examples

The future tense is used to describe future events that haven't occurred but possibly will occur in the future. It is a form of the verb that will occur in the future & not exist currently. Examples

- She will be dancing to classical music.
- We will be shifting to the house upstate tomorrow morning.
- The train will leave in 10 minutes.

Simple Future Tense Rules

The simple future tense represents the actions that will occur in the future i.e., I will go to the movie tomorrow. Now you can create some sentences by using the simple future tense rules which are given below:

Subject + will/shall + V1 + Object

Examples of Simple Future Tense Rules:

1. I shall go to school tomorrow.
2. My mother will feed me.

Future Continuous Tense Rules

The future continuous tense represents the actions that will occur in the future and will be ongoing at a specific point in time i.e., I will be going to a movie at 7 PM tomorrow. Now you can create some sentences by using the future continuous tense rules which are given below:

Subject + will be/shall be + ing + V1 + Object

Examples:

1. He shall be writing his exam.
2. We will be going to the zoo.

Future Perfect Tense Rules

The future perfect tense represents the actions that will be completed before a specific point in time in future i.e., By this time tomorrow, he shall have finished their class. Now you can create some sentences by using the future perfect tense rules which are given below:

Subject + will have/shall have + V3 + Object

Examples of Future Perfect Tense Rules:

I shall have started writing by that time.

We will have reached Goa by then.

Future Perfect Continuous Tense Rules

The future perfect continuous tense represents the actions that will continue up until a specific point in time in future i.e., He will have been waiting there for five hours by seven o'clock.. Now you can create some sentences by using the future perfect continuous tense rules which are given below:

Subject + will have been + V1 + ing + Object

Examples on Future Perfect Continuous Tense:

By next year we will be graduating.

They shall be serving food in the slum area tomorrow.

Voice

The term 'voice' is a term that is used to denote the form of the [verb](#) which shows if the subject in a given sentence is the doer or receiver of the action. The voice of a verb describes the relationship between the action and the participants ([subject](#) or [object](#)) in a sentence.

There are two voices in the English language and they are as follows:

- Active Voice
- Passive Voice

The active voice, in a sentence, denotes that the [noun](#) or [pronoun](#) that acts as the subject in the sentence is the doer of the action. In other words, the subject performs the action or acts upon the verb.

The passive voice, on the other hand, represents that the subject is one acted upon by the action or verb in the sentence. It can also be said that the passive voice indicates that the subject in the sentence is no longer active but passive.

Active Voice – Subject + Verb + Object

Passive Voice – Object + Verb + Subject

Active Voice	Passive Voice
• Denotes that the subject is performing the action.	• Denotes that the subject is acted upon by the verb or action in the sentence.
• The active voice does not require a linking verb to make sense.	• The passive voice uses a linking verb followed by the past participle of the main verb.
• The active voice focuses on the doer of the action.	• The passive voice comes in handy when the doer of the action is undetermined.
• Has a direct, clear and strong tone.	• Has an indirect, weak and subtle tone.
• Examples: • I decorated the hall. • Devi gave Shanthi a gift.	• Examples: • The hall was decorated by me. • Shanthi was given a gift by Devi.

Steps to change the Active Voice to Passive Voice:

- Identify whether the verb in the sentence is *transitive* or *intransitive*.
- Only *transitive verbs* take objects and can be written in the passive voice.
- Identify *the subject*, *the verb* and *the object* in a sentence.
- Interchange the places of *the subject* and *the object*.
- Identify the tense of the verb and use the suitable 'be' **form** and *V3 (Past Participle)* in the passive voice.
- We use prepositions like *by*, *with* or *to* in passive voice.
- When there are *two objects* in a sentence, two *passive sentences* can be written with two objects.
- All Perfect Continuous Tenses and Future Continuous Tense cannot be changed into passive voice.
- We don't generally mention *by + the agent* at the end of the sentence in the passive voice:
 - When the agent is unknown, (like *somebody*, *nobody*, etc.,)
 - When the agent is easy to understand, (like, *police*, *court*, *people* etc.,)
 - When the agent is unimportant
- All the modal verbs (*can*, *could*, *shall*, *should*, *will*, *would*, *must*, *have to*, *had to*, *has to*, *need to*, *ought to*) take *Be + Past Participle* form in Passive Voice.

Tense	Active Voice	Passive Voice
Present Simple	play/plays	<i>am, is, are</i> + played
Present Continuous	am, is, are + playing	am, is, are + <i>being</i> + played
Present Perfect	have/has + played	have/has + <i>been</i> + played
Present Perfect Continuous	have/has + been + playing	No Passive Voice
Past Simple	played	<i>was, were</i> + played
Past Continuous	was, were + playing	<i>was, were</i> + <i>being</i> + played
Past Perfect	had + played	had + <i>been</i> + played
Past Perfect Continuous	had + been + playing	No Passive Voice
Future Simple	shall/will + play	shall/will + <i>be</i> + played
Future Continuous	shall/will + playing	No Passive Voice
Future Perfect	shall/will + have + been	shall/will + have + <i>been</i> + played
Future Perfect Continuous	shall/ will + have + been + playing	No Passive Voice

Change of Pronouns *subjective to objective*:

Subjective Pronoun	Objective Pronoun
I	me
we	us
you	you
he	him
she	her
it	it
they	them

Tenses	Voice	Present Tense	Past Tense	Future Tense
Simple	Active	She plays chess.	She played chess.	She will play chess.
	Passive	<i>Chess is played by her.</i>	<i>Chess was played by her.</i>	<i>Chess will be played by her.</i>
Continuous	Active	She is playing chess.	She was playing chess.	She will be playing chess.
	Passive	<i>Chess is being played by her.</i>	<i>Chess was being played by her.</i>	No Passive Voice
Perfect	Active	She has played chess.	She had played chess.	She will have played chess
	Passive	<i>Chess has been played by her</i>	<i>Chess had been played by her.</i>	<i>Chess will have been played by her.</i>
Perfect Continuous	Active	She has been playing chess.	She had been playing chess.	She will have been playing chess.
	Passive	No Passive Voice	No Passive Voice	No Passive Voice

Modals in the Passive Voice

Modals: Can, could, shall, should, will, would, may, might <i>must, have to ought to, etc.,</i>	<i>Active</i>	She can play chess.	She could play chess.	She might play chess.
	<i>Passive</i>	<i>Chess can be played by her.</i>	<i>Chess could be played by her.</i>	<i>Chess might be played by her.</i>
	<i>Active</i>	She may play chess.	She might play chess.	She has to play chess.
	<i>Passive</i>	<i>Chess may be played by her.</i>	<i>Chess might be played by her.</i>	<i>Chess has to be played by her.</i>

Narration / Direct and Indirect Speech

The art of reporting the words of a speaker is called Narration.

There are two main ways of reporting the words of a speaker.

1. Direct Speech

2. Indirect Speech

Direct Speech

In this form, the actual words of the speaker are put in quotes "".

Ex:-

1. Rama said, "I am very busy now."
2. In the above example the Speaker i.e
3. **Rama** is known as **Reporter**,
4. **said** is known as **Reporting verb** and
5. **"I am very busy now."** is known as **Reported Speech**.

Indirect Speech

In this form, the actual words of the speaker are transformed and said/written in a simple manner.

Ex:-

- Rama said that he was very busy then.

Basic rules to convert a Direct Speech to Indirect Speech.

There are five basic things that have to be changed while converting a **Direct speech** to an **Indirect speech**.

1. To change the reporting verb according to the reported speech.
2. To remove the inverted comma's from the direct speech and replace them with an appropriate conjunction.
3. To change the pronoun of reported speech accordingly.
4. Change the adverbs of the Direct Speech.

Active - Rajiv said to me, "I shall go to the picture today"

Passive - Rajiv told me that he would go to the picture that day.

In the above example

Reporting verb **said to** is changed into **told**.
 Inverted Commas are replaced by the conjunction **that**
 Reported speech's pronoun **I** is changed into **He**.
 Reported speech's verb **shall go** is changed into **would go**.
 As another change **today** is changed with the word that **day**.

Rules of change of Pronouns

Nominative	Possessive	Objective	Reflexive
I	My	Me	Myself
We	Our	Us	Ourselves
You	Yours	You	Yourself
He	His	Him	Himself
She	Her	Her	Herself
They	Their	Them	Themselves

Pronouns are changed according to a rule designated as **SON where**

- **S** stands for **Subject**
- **O** stands for **Object**
- **N** stands for **No change**.

1. First person changes to subject of Reporting Verb
2. Second person changes to Object of Reporting Verb
3. There is no change if it is a Third person.

Rule No 1.

1st Person pronoun of Reported speech is changed according to the Subject of Reporting verb.

Direct: She says, "I am in tenth class."

Indirect: She says that she is in tenth class.

Direct: I say, "I am an honest man."

Indirect: I say that I am an honest man.

Rule No 2.

2nd Person pronoun of Reported speech is changed according to Object of Reporting verb.

Direct: She says to me, "you have done your work"

Indirect: She tells me that I have done my work.

Direct: She says to her, "You have done your work"

Indirect: She tells her that she has done her work.

Direct: I say to them, "you have done your work."

Indirect: I tell them that they have done their work.

Rule No 3.

3rd Person Pronoun of Reported speech is not changed.

Direct: He says, "He does not work hard"

Indirect: He says that he does not work hard.

Direct: Everybody says, "They have spoken the truth"

Indirect: Everybody says that they have spoken the truth.

Rules of change of verb or Tense

Rule No.1

If reporting verb is given in **Present or Future** tense then there will be **no change** in the verb or tense of Reported speech

Direct: The teacher says, "Gayatri performs on the stage"

Indirect: The teacher says that Gayatri performs on the stage.

Direct: The teacher is saying, "Gayatri performs on the stage"

Indirect: The teacher is saying that Gayatri performs on the stage.

Direct: The teacher will say, "Gayatri is performing on the stage"

Indirect: The teacher will say that Gayatri is performing on the stage.

Rule No.2

If reporting verb is given in **Past** tense then the tense of the verb of Reported Speech will change into corresponding **Past tense**.

Direct: The teacher said, "I am suffering from fever."

Indirect: The teacher said that she was suffering from fever.

Direct: She said to me, "I took the breakfast in the morning".

Indirect: She told me that she had taken the breakfast in the morning.

Corresponding Changes to past form in **an indirect speech** from the **verb in Reported speech**.

1. **Simple present** changes to **Simple Past**
2. **Present Continuous** changes to **Past Continuous**
3. **Present Perfect** changes to **Past Perfect**
4. **Present Perfect Continuous** changes to **Past Perfect Continuous**
5. **Simple Past** changes to **Past Perfect**
6. **Past Continuous** changes to **Past Perfect Continuous**
7. **In Future Tense will/Shall** changes to **would**
8. **Can** changes to **Could**
9. **May** changes to **Might**

Some of the exceptional cases of **Rule 2**

Exception 1:

If Reporting speech has **Universal Truth** or **Habitual fact** then there is no change in the Tense.

Direct: Our teacher said, "The earth is round"

Indirect: Our teacher said that the earth is round.(Universal Truth)

Direct: Rajiv said to me, "He plays with right hand"

Indirect: Rajiv told me that he plays with the right hand.(Habitual fact)

Exception 2:

If reporting speech has **Past Historical Fact** then there is no change in the Tense.

Direct: Our teacher said, "Asoka left war after the conquest of Kalinga".

Indirect: Our teacher said that Asoka left war after the conquest of Kalinga.

Exception 3:

If Reporting speech has **two actions to be happening at a time when** there is no change in the Tense.

Direct: She said "My wife was making lunch when I was studying"

Indirect: She said that her wife was making lunch when she was studying.

Exception 4:

If Reporting speech has some **Imagined Condition** then there is no change in the Tense.

Direct: She said, "If I were rich, I would help him."

Indirect: She said that if she were rich she would help her.

Exception 5:

If Reporting speech contains had 3rd form, to-infinitive and would, could, should, must, might, ought to etc. then there is no change in the Tense.

Direct: She said to me, "You should obey your elders."

Indirect: She told me that I should obey my elders.

Some other small changes that used to take place while changing Direct Speech to Indirect Speech.

Here	Changes to	There
Now	Changes to	Then
This	Changes to	That
These	Changes to	Those
Today	Changes to	That day
To-night	Changes to	That night
Yesterday	Changes to	The previous day
Last night	Changes to	The previous night
Last week	Changes to	The previous week
Tomorrow	Changes to	The next day
Next Week	Changes to	The following week
Ago	Changes to	Before
Thus	Changes to	so
Hence	Changes to	Thence
Hither	Changes to	Thither
Come	Changes to	Go

Note:-An in indirect speech we talk about such incidents that are after the time of reporting and had happened away from the place of reporting therefore the words that show nearness has to be replaced by the words that show distance.

Some exception in these changes

1. **Come** is changed to **go** if there is some word given after **come** that shows nearness.

2. If **this**, **here** and **now** points to such a thing, place or time that is in front of the speaker then no change takes place in Indirect Narration.

Rules for Change in Narration of different type of sentences**Type No 1. Assertive Sentences****Rule 1**

- If there is no object after Reporting verb there it should not be changed.
- If there is some object after Reporting verb then **say** is changed to **tell, says to tells** and **said to told**.
- According to the context **said to** can be replaced by replied, informed, stated, added, remarked, asserted, assured, pleaded, reminded, reported or complained etc.

Rule 2

- Put conjunction that in place of " ".
- Change the pronouns of the Reported speech as enlisted earlier.

Examples showing some Assertive Sentences Changed into Indirect form

Direct: She said to me, "I shall sleep now"

Indirect: She told me that she would play then.

Direct: He said, "My brother's marriage comes off next month."

Indirect: He said that his brother's marriage would come off the following month.

Type No 2. Interrogative Sentences

Rule 1

- An interrogative sentence is meant to ask questions, therefore, Reporting verb **said/said to** is changed to **asked**.
- **Said to** can also be changed into **enquired** or **demanded**

Rule 2

- If question is formed with the help of any of the helping verbs like is/are/am, was/were, has/have, do/does, will/would etc then " ___ " are to be replaced by **if** or **whether**
- If the question is formed with the help of words starting with "Wh" like who, whose, what, whom, when etc (also known as W family) or How then to replace " ___ " **no conjunction** is used.

Rule 3

- In these sentences **question form** of the sentence is removed and **full-stop** is put at the end of the sentence.
- Helping verb is /are/am, was/were etc should be put after the subject.
- If the interrogative sentence is expressing positive feeling then do/does of the Direct speech is removed while converting it into Indirect speech.
- If the interrogative sentence is expressing negative feeling then do/does of the Direct speech is changed into did while converting it into Indirect speech.
- Did or has/have the interrogative sentence is changed to had.

Rule 4

- Pronouns and verbs are changed according to the set rule of Narration.



Communication Skills

Unit – 3

Word Formation

Word formation refers to the process of creating new words or modifying existing ones. In English, words are often formed by adding prefixes or suffixes, or through compounding and blending.

- **Prefix:** A group of letters added at the beginning of a word to change its meaning.
Example: **un-** (unhappy), **re-** (replay), **pre-** (preheat)
- **Suffix:** A group of letters added at the end of a word to change its meaning or grammatical function.
Example: **-ly** (quick → quickly), **-ness** (happy → happiness), **-ment** (develop → development)
- **Compounding:** Combining two or more words to form a new word.
Example: **notebook**, **sunlight**, **teacup**
- **Blending:** Merging parts of two words to create a new word.
Example: **brunch** (breakfast + lunch), **smog** (smoke + fog)

Synonyms and Antonyms

Synonyms are words that have similar meanings, while **antonyms** are words with opposite meanings.

- **Synonyms Examples:**
 - **Happy:** joyful, content, elated
 - **Big:** large, huge, gigantic
 - **Quick:** fast, rapid, swift
- **Antonyms Examples:**
 - **Happy:** sad, miserable, unhappy
 - **Big:** small, tiny, little
 - **Quick:** slow, sluggish, delayed

Synonyms (Words with Similar Meanings)

Happy → Joyful, content, pleased, elated, cheerful

Big → Large, huge, enormous, gigantic, massive

Beautiful → Pretty, attractive, lovely, stunning, gorgeous

Brave → Courageous, valiant, fearless, bold, heroic

Smart → Intelligent, clever, bright, wise, sharp

Fast → Quick, speedy, swift, rapid, brisk

Cold → Chilly, frosty, icy, cool, freezing

Strong → Powerful, sturdy, robust, tough, muscular

Quiet → Silent, calm, peaceful, serene, tranquil

Angry → Furious, enraged, irate, mad, livid

Antonyms (Words with Opposite Meanings)

Happy → Sad, miserable, unhappy, gloomy, sorrowful

Big → Small, tiny, little, miniature, compact

Beautiful → Ugly, unattractive, plain, hideous, unappealing

Brave → Cowardly, fearful, timid, afraid, scared

Smart → Stupid, dull, foolish, unintelligent, ignorant

Fast → Slow, sluggish, delayed, leisurely, gradual

Cold → Hot, warm, heated, scorching, fiery

Strong → Weak, frail, fragile, delicate, feeble

Quiet → Noisy, loud, boisterous, rowdy, clamorous

Angry → Calm, peaceful, serene, composed, tranquil

Words Often Confused

Some words in English sound or look similar but have different meanings. It's essential to understand and differentiate between them.

Accept vs. Except → *Accept*: to receive; *Except*: to exclude

Affect vs. Effect → *Affect*: to influence; *Effect*: result

Advice vs. Advise → *Advice*: suggestion (noun); *Advise*: to suggest (verb)

Complement vs. Compliment → *Complement*: something that completes; *Compliment*: praise

Allusion vs. Illusion → *Allusion*: indirect reference; *Illusion*: false perception

Stationary vs. Stationery → *Stationary*: not moving; *Stationery*: writing materials

Principal vs. Principle → *Principal*: head of a school; *Principle*: fundamental truth

Desert vs. Dessert → *Desert*: dry land; *Dessert*: sweet food

Elicit vs. Illicit → *Elicit*: to draw out; *Illicit*: illegal

Loose vs. Lose → *Loose*: not tight; *Lose*: to misplace

One-Word Substitutes

One-word substitutes are single words that can replace longer phrases or expressions. Learning these can make writing more concise and precise.

A person who loves books → Bibliophile

A place where animals are kept → Zoo

A person who cannot read or write → Illiterate

A government by the people → Democracy

The study of human societies → Anthropology
A remedy for all diseases → Panacea
A life story written by oneself → Autobiography
A person who does not believe in God → Atheist
One who loves his country → Patriot
A person who looks on the bright side of things → Optimist

Idioms and Phrasal Verbs

Idioms are phrases with meanings that are different from the literal meanings of their individual words. **Phrasal verbs** are verbs combined with prepositions or adverbs that create a new meaning.

Idioms

A blessing in disguise → Something good that isn't recognized at first
Break the ice → Start a conversation in a social setting
Hit the nail on the head → Get something exactly right
Bite the bullet → Face something difficult with courage
A piece of cake → Something that is very easy to do
Under the weather → Feeling unwell or sick
Burn the midnight oil → Stay up late working or studying
Cut corners → Do something in a cheaper or easier way
Once in a blue moon → Rarely happens
The ball is in your court → It's up to you to make the next decision

Phrasal Verbs

Look up → To search for information
Give up → To stop trying
Take off → To leave the ground (for airplanes) or to succeed suddenly
Get along → To have a friendly relationship
Bring up → To raise a topic or a child
Call off → To cancel
Put off → To postpone
Run into → To meet someone unexpectedly
Turn down → To reject an offer
Work out → To exercise or solve a problem

Abbreviations of Scientific and Technical Words

In scientific and technical fields, abbreviations are frequently used to save time and space. These abbreviations are often formed using the first letters of a phrase.

- CPU** ➔ Central Processing Unit
- RAM** ➔ Random Access Memory
- ROM** ➔ Read-Only Memory
- LAN** ➔ Local Area Network
- WAN** ➔ Wide Area Network
- Wi-Fi** ➔ Wireless Fidelity
- USB** ➔ Universal Serial Bus
- GPS** ➔ Global Positioning System
- HTML** ➔ Hyper Text Markup Language
- AI** ➔ Artificial Intelligence

Communication Skills

Unit 4

1. Introduction to Phonetic Sounds & Articulation

Phonetic sounds are the building blocks of spoken language. They can be classified into two main categories: vowels and consonants.

- **Vowels:** These sounds are produced without any significant blockage of airflow. In English, the vowel sounds include /a/, /e/, /i/, /o/, /u/, and can vary in length and quality (e.g., short vs. long vowels).
- **Consonants:** These sounds are created by obstructing airflow in some way, using the tongue, lips, or teeth. For example, the /t/ sound is made by placing the tongue against the upper teeth and releasing air.

Articulation refers to the physical movement of the mouth and vocal cords to produce these sounds. The key articulators include:

- **Tongue:** Helps in forming both vowels and consonants.
- **Lips:** Essential for sounds like /b/ and /p/.
- **Teeth:** Important for sounds like /f/ and /v/.

Understanding these sounds is crucial for accurate pronunciation and effective communication.

2. Word Accent

Word accent indicates which syllable in a word is stressed. Stressing the correct syllable is vital, as it can change the meaning of a word.

For example:

- The word “record” can be pronounced with the stress on the first syllable (REcord) when used as a noun, referring to a document or an account.
- However, when used as a verb, the stress shifts to the second syllable (reCORD), meaning to capture sound or video.

Accurate word accentuation improves clarity in speech and aids in comprehension. It helps listeners identify the intended meaning of words that may otherwise sound similar.

3. Rhythm and Intonation

Rhythm in speech refers to the pattern of sounds in spoken language, created by alternating stressed and unstressed syllables. This natural cadence makes speech flow smoothly and keeps the listener engaged.

For instance, in the phrase “I would like to order a pizza,” the stressed words may be “like,” “order,” and “pizza.” Stressed words carry the essential meaning, while unstressed words provide grammatical structure.

Intonation, on the other hand, involves the rise and fall of pitch while speaking. It serves several functions:

Questions often have a rising intonation at the end, indicating uncertainty or inquiry (e.g., “Are you coming?”).

Statements usually have a falling intonation, conveying certainty (e.g., “I am coming.”).

Both rhythm and intonation contribute to the emotional tone of speech and help convey the speaker's intent, making communication more effective.

4. Interpersonal Communication

Interpersonal communication is the process of exchanging information, ideas, and feelings between people. It is characterized by the following components:

- **Verbal Communication:** This includes spoken or written language. Clarity and choice of words are vital for effective verbal communication.
- **NonVerbal Communication:** Body language, facial expressions, eye contact, and gestures play a crucial role in conveying meaning and emotions. For example, crossed arms may indicate defensiveness, while maintaining eye contact shows confidence and engagement.

Key Skills in Interpersonal Communication:

- **Active Listening:** This involves fully concentrating on what the other person is saying, rather than just passively hearing their words. Techniques include nodding, summarizing, and asking clarifying questions.
- **Empathy:** Understanding and sharing the feelings of another person is essential for building rapport and trust. Showing empathy can lead to more meaningful connections.
- **Feedback:** Providing constructive feedback helps clarify understanding and promotes open dialogue.

These skills are essential in both personal relationships and professional settings, facilitating collaboration and reducing misunderstandings.

5. Oral Presentation

An oral presentation is a formal talk given to an audience, often supported by visual aids like slides. Effective presentations require careful planning and delivery.

Key Components of Successful Oral Presentations:

- **Content Organization:** Structure your presentation with a clear introduction, body, and conclusion. Start with an engaging opening statement, present your main points with supporting details, and summarize key takeaways at the end.
- **Engagement Techniques:** Use eye contact, gestures, and questions to connect with your audience. Encourage participation by asking questions or prompting discussion.
- **Visual Aids:** Utilize slides, charts, or videos to enhance understanding. Ensure they are clear and relevant, and avoid cluttering slides with too much text.
- **Practice and Rehearsal:** Familiarity with your material will boost confidence and help you deliver smoothly. Practicing in front of others can also provide valuable feedback.

6. Language and Voice Modulation (Paralinguistics and NonVerbal Communication)

Voice modulation refers to the ability to change your voice's pitch, tone, volume, and speed to convey meaning and emotion effectively. It adds a layer of expressiveness to your speech.

- **Pitch:** The highness or lowness of your voice can indicate excitement or seriousness. For instance, a higher pitch may convey enthusiasm, while a lower pitch can express authority.
- **Tone:** The emotional quality of your voice can influence how your message is received. A warm tone can create a friendly atmosphere, while a harsh tone may lead to misunderstandings.
- **Volume:** Adjusting the loudness of your speech can emphasize important points. Speaking softly can draw attention, while raising your voice can signal urgency.

NonVerbal Communication includes body language, facial expressions, and gestures. These elements can reinforce or contradict what you say. For example:

- Nodding while speaking can indicate agreement or affirmation.
- A smile can convey warmth and friendliness, while crossed arms may suggest defensiveness or discomfort.

Together, paralinguistics and nonverbal cues enhance communication by providing context and emotional depth.

7. Negotiation and Persuasion

Negotiation is a dialogue between two or more parties aimed at reaching an agreement. It involves understanding different perspectives, making compromises, and finding common ground.

Key Strategies for Successful Negotiation:

Preparation: Research and understand the needs and interests of all parties involved. Knowing your objectives and limits helps in formulating effective strategies.

Active Listening: Demonstrating genuine interest in the other party's concerns fosters goodwill and encourages open dialogue.

Compromise: Be willing to adjust your position to achieve a mutually beneficial outcome. Flexibility can lead to creative solutions that satisfy both sides.

Persuasion is the art of convincing someone to accept your viewpoint or take action. Effective persuasion relies on several key techniques:

Building Credibility: Establish yourself as knowledgeable and trustworthy to gain respect and influence.

Emotional Appeal: Use stories or personal experiences to connect with the audience emotionally, making your argument more compelling.

Logical Argumentation: Present clear, logical reasoning backed by data or examples. This helps in persuading those who prefer analytical thinking.

Both negotiation and persuasion are essential skills in various aspects of life, from business dealings to personal relationships.

8. Group Discussion

A group discussion (GD) is a structured conversation among multiple participants about a specific topic. It is often used in educational settings and interviews to assess communication skills, teamwork, and critical thinking.

Key Elements of Effective Group Discussions:

- **Clear Topic:** A welldefined topic sets the stage for a focused discussion. Participants should be aware of the subject matter and objectives.
- **Participation:** All group members should contribute their thoughts and ideas. Encouraging quieter members to speak up can lead to richer discussions.
- **Respect and Openmindedness:** Acknowledge differing opinions and be respectful. Healthy disagreements can stimulate critical thinking and lead to better solutions.

Roles in Group Discussions:

- **Facilitator:** Guides the discussion, ensuring everyone has a chance to speak and keeps the conversation on track.
- **Notetaker:** Records key points and decisions made during the discussion for future reference.
- **Timekeeper:** Ensures that the discussion adheres to the allotted time, preventing any one person from dominating.

Successful group discussions require collaboration, effective communication, and a willingness to consider diverse viewpoints.

9. Interview Techniques (Telephonic and Video Conferencing)

Interview techniques are essential skills for succeeding in job interviews, whether conducted over the phone or through video conferencing.

Telephonic Interviews:

- **Preparation:** Research the company and role beforehand. Prepare answers to common interview questions.
- **Clear Communication:** Speak clearly and at a moderate pace, as the interviewer relies solely on auditory cues. Avoid filler words and maintain a professional tone.
- **Environment:** Conduct the interview in a quiet location, free from distractions. This allows you to focus and communicate effectively.

Video Conferencing Interviews:

- **Technical Setup:** Test your internet connection, microphone, and camera before the interview. Familiarize yourself with the video conferencing platform being used.
- **NonVerbal Cues:** Maintain eye contact by looking at the camera rather than the screen. Use appropriate facial expressions and gestures to convey engagement.
- **Professional Appearance:** Dress as you would for an inperson interview and ensure your background is tidy and free from distractions.

Both interview types require preparation, effective communication, and a professional demeanor to leave a positive impression on potential employers.

Communication Skills

Unit – 5

1. Job Application

A **job application** is a formal request for employment submitted to an organization. It typically includes a cover letter and a resume/CV.

Key Components:

- **Cover Letter:** This should introduce you to the employer, express your interest in the position, and highlight your qualifications. It should be tailored to the specific job and company.
- **Resume/CV:** A concise document that outlines your work history, education, skills, and relevant experiences. Focus on accomplishments and quantify achievements where possible.

Tips:

- Research the company and tailor your application to reflect how your skills match their needs.
- Proofread for spelling and grammar errors to ensure professionalism.

[Your Address]
[City, State, ZIP Code]
[Your Email Address]
[Your Phone Number]
[Date]

[Employer's Name]
[Company Name]
[Company Address]
[City, State, ZIP Code]

Dear [Employer's Name],

I am writing to express my strong interest in the [Job Title] position at [Company Name], as advertised on [Job Posting Source]. With a proven track record in [mention relevant experience or skills], I am confident that my qualifications align perfectly with the requirements of this role.

In my previous position at [Your Previous Company], I consistently [highlight key achievements or responsibilities] which demonstrate my ability to [mention key skills or qualities relevant to the job]. I am eager to bring my expertise to your team and contribute to the continued success of [Company Name].

Enclosed is my resume, which provides more details about my qualifications and accomplishments. I am excited about the opportunity to discuss how my experience and skills can benefit [Company Name]. Thank you for considering my application.

Sincerely,
[Your Name]

CV Writing

A **Curriculum Vitae (CV)** is a detailed document that showcases your academic and professional accomplishments. It is commonly used in academic, medical, and research fields.

Structure:

- **Contact Information:** Your name, phone number, email, and LinkedIn profile (if applicable).
- **Personal Statement:** A brief summary of your career goals and qualifications.
- **Education:** List your degrees, institutions, and graduation dates in reverse chronological order.
- **Work Experience:** Include job titles, employers, locations, and dates, with bullet points describing your responsibilities and achievements.
- **Skills:** Highlight relevant skills, such as technical abilities or languages.
- **Publications and Presentations:** If applicable, list any research papers, articles, or conference presentations.
- **References:** Include contacts who can vouch for your professional qualifications (if required).

Tips:

- Keep the CV clear and well-organized, using headings and bullet points for readability.
- Tailor the content to the specific role or field you are applying for.

Michael More

Business and Marketing Graduate

Organized & hard-working business and marketing graduate looking to join a start-up in New York as a marketing assistant or intern. Looking to take advantage of my skills and knowledge in Digital Marketing and PR to help XYZ Inc. with their marketing efforts.

 michael@novoresume.com

 (541) 231-2414

 Chicago, IL

 linkedin.com/in/michael.more

EDUCATION

MS in Business and Marketing Management

The University of Chicago

09/2021 - 06/2023

GPA: 3.95

Thesis

- From Idea to an IPO: How marketing, more than technology, makes start-ups succeed.

BS in International Business and Marketing

The University of Chicago

09/2018 - 06/2021

GPA: 3.90

Main Courses

- E-commerce and Consumer Behaviour
- Social Media and Email Marketing
- PR and Marketing Research

INTERSHIPS

Internship Program - Sales & Marketing Department

Pear Inc.

06/2022 - 12/2022

Achievements

- Increased the company's social media engagement by 25% through the creation of weekly content plans and the use of social media analytics tools to identify trends and improve post engagement.
- Conducted market research on the company's target demographic, resulting in the identification of a new target audience and an increase in potential leads by 30%.

VOLUNTEER EXPERIENCE

Volunteer in the Business and Marketing Student Organization

The University of Chicago

03/2018 - 10/2021

Achievements

- In charge of organizing and promoting kick-off activities for approximately 300 international students in 2017, 2018 and 2019.
- Increased the social media presence of the student organization by 48% from 2017 to 2018 and by 65% between 2018 and 2019 by creating weekly relevant and entertaining content for the students.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Digital Marketing

Google Ads. Google Analytics. Facebook for Business. ActiveCampaign. A/B Testing.

Research and Data Analysis

Proficient User in Microsoft Excel and Powerpoint. Mendeley. Remash. SurveyMonkey. Typeform.

SOFT SKILLS

Time Management

Efficiency

Verbal and Written Communication

Teamwork

Storytelling

3. Business Letters

A **business letter** is a formal document used for communication between organizations or individuals. It follows a specific format and is used for various purposes, such as inquiries, requests, or complaints.

Structure:

- **Sender's Address:** Your address at the top right corner.
- **Date:** The date you are writing the letter.
- **Recipient's Address:** The address of the person you are writing to, on the left side below the date.
- **Salutation:** Use formal greetings (e.g., “**Dear Mr. Smith,**”).
- **Body:** Clearly state the purpose of the letter, providing necessary details. Use clear, concise language.
- **Closing:** End with a formal closing (e.g., “**Sincerely,**” or “**Best regards,**”) followed by your signature and printed name.

Tips:

- Keep it professional and to the point.
- Proofread to avoid errors.

The diagram illustrates the structure of a business letter within a rectangular frame. On the left, four numbered boxes are connected to their respective sections in the letter template by colored lines: 1. Heading (orange), 2. Salutation (purple), 3. Body (red), and 4. Sign-off (teal).

1. Heading points to the top right corner, containing:
[Your name]
[Your address]
[Your contact info]
[Date sent]

2. Salutation points to the line below the heading, containing:
Dear [recipient name],

3. Body points to the main content area, represented by four horizontal lines.

4. Sign-off points to the bottom right, containing:
Sincerely,
[Your signature]
[Your typed name]

1. Heading

Basic documentation; justified either on the left or right and separated from the salutation by a paragraph break

2. Salutation

A greeting to the recipient; usually "Dear" and recipient's full name, followed by a paragraph break before the first body paragraph

3. Body

The message of the letter; either fully justified with a line break in between each paragraph or with first lines indented .5" and no line breaks in between paragraphs

4. Sign-off

Separated from the body by a paragraph break and justified on the same side as the heading; usually "Sincerely," followed on the next line by your signature and then your typed full name on the following line

4. Memos

A **memo** (short for memorandum) is an informal document used within an organization to communicate policies, procedures, or other important information.

Structure:

- **Header:** Includes **To**, **From**, **Date**, and **Subject** lines.
- **Body:** Start with a clear introduction stating the purpose of the memo. Provide details and recommendations.
- **Conclusion:** Summarize the main points or suggest actions to be taken.

Tips:

- Keep memos concise and focused on the main message.
- Use bullet points or numbered lists for clarity.

Memorandum

To: [Audience]

From: [Person and/or Department issuing the memo]

Date: [Date Sent]

Subject: [Subject of the Memo]

[Opening – Get to the point in the opening paragraph. Keep things simple and short. Make it easy and fast to read. Visit the [Memo Template](#) page on Vertex42.com for more tips.]

[Summary – Summarize any historical or contextual information needed to support the opening paragraph.]

|

[Conclusion – End with a call to action.]

CC: [Send copies to anyone affected by the memo.]

Attachments: [List any attachments to the memo. Only list items referred to in the body of the memo.]

5. Minutes

Minutes are official records of a meeting, documenting what was discussed and decided.

Structure:

- **Heading:** Include the title of the meeting, date, time, and attendees.
- **Call to Order:** Note when the meeting started.
- **Approval of Previous Minutes:** Mention if the last meeting's minutes were approved.
- **Discussion Points:** Summarize key discussions, decisions made, and actions assigned to individuals.
- **Adjournment:** Note when the meeting ended.

Tips:

- Write minutes while the meeting is in progress to capture details accurately.
- Use clear and concise language, sticking to essential information.

Meeting Title

Date and Time:
Venue:
Requested by:

Meeting Attendees

- Attendee 1
- Attendee 2
- Attendee 3

Agenda

- Agenda 1
- Agenda 2
- Agenda 3

Discussion

- Discussion Point 1
- Discussion Point 2
- Discussion Point 3

Action Items

- Write here

Next Meeting

- Write here

Additional Notes

- Write here

6. Notices

A **notice** is a formal announcement intended to inform employees or stakeholders about specific information, such as events, changes in policies, or deadlines.

Structure:

- **Title:** Clearly state “**Notice**” at the top.
- **Date:** Include the date of the notice.
- **Body:** Clearly state the purpose of the notice. Use bullet points for important information.
- **Contact Information:** Provide details of whom to contact for questions or clarifications.

Tips:

- Be clear and direct to ensure the information is easily understood.
- Keep it brief but informative.

XYZ HIGH SCHOOL, DELHI

Notice

13th Oct 2020

Cultural Department Meeting

The School authority has decided to organise a programme on Children’s Day. Therefore, a meeting will be held at 11a.m at the auditorium for the cultural department to discuss about the arrangements. You all are requested to attend the same.

(Secretary of Cultural Programme Department)

Report Writing & Structure

A **report** is a structured document that presents information clearly and succinctly, often used for analysis, findings, and recommendations.

Structure:

- **Title Page:** Include the report title, author, and date.
- **Table of Contents:** List the main sections and page numbers for easy navigation.
- **Executive Summary:** A brief overview of the report's main points and conclusions.
- **Introduction:** Explain the purpose and scope of the report.
- **Methodology:** Describe the methods used to gather information (if applicable).
- **Findings/Results:** Present data, observations, and analysis.
- **Discussion:** Interpret the findings and discuss their implications.
- **Conclusion and Recommendations:** Summarize key points and suggest actions based on findings.
- **References:** List any sources cited in the report.

Tips:

- Use headings and subheadings for organization.
- Include visuals (charts, graphs) to support data and enhance understanding.

8. Email Etiquette

Email etiquette refers to the principles of composing and sending emails in a professional manner. It's important for effective communication in the workplace.

Key Guidelines:

- **Clear Subject Line:** Summarize the email's purpose concisely.
- **Professional Greeting:** Use appropriate salutations (e.g., “**Dear [Name],**”).
- **Concise and Clear Content:** Get straight to the point. Use short paragraphs and bullet points to improve readability.
- **Formal Language:** Avoid slang and casual language. Maintain professionalism throughout.
- **Closing:** End with a courteous closing (e.g., “**Best regards,**” or “**Thank you,**”) and include your contact information.

Tips:

- Proofread for spelling and grammar errors before sending.
- Avoid using all caps or excessive punctuation, as it can be perceived as shouting.

Email Etiquette Tip: Keep your tone professional.

“

Dear [Prospect name],

It was great to speak with you on the phone earlier. I hope those spring storms give you a break soon!

You should have received a calendar invite from me for the demo we agreed upon for Tuesday, April 7 at 2:00 p.m. EST. You'll also find an agenda and talking points attached below.

Please let me know if you have any questions.

Regards,
[Your name]

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9. Blog Writing

Blog writing involves creating engaging, informative, and relevant content for an online audience. Blogs can cover a wide range of topics and serve various purposes, from personal opinions to professional advice.

Structure:

- **Title:** A catchy, descriptive title that draws readers in.
- **Introduction:** Start with an engaging hook to capture attention. Briefly outline what the blog will cover.
- **Body:** Break the content into sections with headings. Use short paragraphs, bullet points, and visuals to enhance readability. Provide valuable insights, tips, or personal stories.
- **Conclusion:** Summarize the key points and invite reader engagement (e.g., ask a question or encourage comments).
- **Call to Action:** Prompt readers to take a specific action, such as subscribing, sharing, or exploring related content.

Tips:

- Use a conversational tone to make the content relatable.
- Regularly update your blog to keep it fresh and relevant.

How to Start a blog :

1. Understand your audience.
2. Check out your competition.
3. Determine what topics you'll cover.
4. Identify your unique angle.
5. Name your blog.
6. Create your blog domain.
7. Choose a CMS and set up your blog.
8. Customize the look of your blog.
9. Write your first blog post.

THE BASIC OUTLINE OF ANY BLOG

Intro	1. Come directly to the point & be relatable. 2. Think of the problem the reader may have and what frame of mind they may be in- refer to that. 3. say something that convinces them to read on.
Body	1. Definitions 2. List of points 3. Examples 4. What should reader pay attention to and why 5. Pros & Cons 6. Tips
Conclusion	1. Sum up what you wrote about 2. Tell the reader how this information is going to benefit them 3. Disclaimers 4. Prompt them to take some action

